

Manual App Testing Checklist

A universal QA checklist — apply to ANY feature, screen, or build.

How to use this document: For every feature or screen handed over for testing, run through each section below. This checklist is feature-agnostic — the same checks apply whether the element is a button, form, list, media player, or any other UI component. Mark each item Pass / Fail / NA and log failures with screenshot + steps to reproduce.

1. Types of Manual Testing to Cover

Every complete QA cycle should touch these categories. Not every build needs all of them — pick based on scope of change.

#	Type	What it covers
1	Smoke Testing	Quick check that the build is stable enough to test. App launches, main screens open, no immediate crashes.
2	Functional Testing	Every element does what it is supposed to do. Inputs accept/reject correctly, actions trigger the right result.
3	UI Testing	Visual review. Alignment, spacing, fonts, colors, icons, images, no overlapping or cut-off content.
4	Usability / UX Testing	Is the flow easy to follow? Too many steps? Confusing labels? Unclear error messages?
5	Compatibility Testing	Works across devices, OS versions, screen sizes, and orientations (portrait / landscape).
6	Regression Testing	After any change, re-run old test cases to confirm nothing that was working before is now broken.
7	Interruption Testing	App behaviour during incoming calls, notifications, low battery, lock screen, minimize/resume.
8	Network Testing	Behaviour on WiFi, 4G, slow network, airplane mode, network switching mid-action, no internet.
9	Install / Update / Uninstall Testing	Fresh install, update from older version (data retained), uninstall leaves no residue.
10	Localization Testing	Language switches correctly, translated text fits UI, date / time / number / currency formats are right.
11	Performance Feel Check	Launch time, screen load time, scroll smoothness, animation lag, heating, battery drain — by feel.
12	Accessibility Testing	Font scaling, screen reader, color contrast, tap target size, keyboard navigation.
13	Security (Basic Manual)	Permissions asked correctly, sensitive data not exposed, session timeout, proper sign-out.
14	Exploratory Testing	Unscripted. Tester uses the app freely trying to break it — random taps, odd inputs, weird sequences.

2. Step-by-Step Testing Process

Step 1 — Prepare

Get the build, release notes (what changed), test devices, test accounts, and test data ready.

Step 2 — Write / Update Test Cases

Maintain a test case sheet: Screen → Element → Expected → Actual → Pass/Fail → Severity → Screenshot.

Step 3 — Smoke Test First

Short 10–15 min check. If the build is unstable, stop and return to dev. Do not waste time on deeper tests.

Step 4 — Functional Pass

Go element by element, screen by screen. Run every case. Mark Pass / Fail.

Step 5 — UI Pass

Visual review on at least 2–3 different devices / screen sizes.

Step 6 — Flow / Journey Testing

End-to-end walkthrough of every user path from start to finish.

Step 7 — Edge Cases & Interruptions

Network off, call, notification, background / foreground, rotate, kill app, resume.

Step 8 — Regression

Re-run the saved regression sheet. Confirm old working areas are still working.

Step 9 — Exploratory

Last pass. Free testing, no script. Try to break the app.

Step 10 — Bug Report & Retest

Log every bug with screenshot, device, OS, steps, severity. After fix, retest only those + quick smoke.

Step 11 — Sign-off

Share final test report: total cases, passed, failed, blockers, known issues. Then green-light release.

3. Universal Element-Level Checklist

Use this on every feature / screen. Each check applies regardless of what the feature does. Tick the box when done; circle if it fails and log a bug.

A. Visual / UI

- All text is readable — no cut-off, no overlap, no truncation.
- Fonts, sizes, and colors match the design specification.
- Alignment and spacing are consistent across the screen.
- Icons and images load fully; no broken or missing assets.
- Screen renders correctly in both portrait and landscape.
- No visual glitches on scrolling, zooming, or resizing.
- Dark mode / light mode (if applicable) renders correctly.
- Loading states, skeletons, and placeholders display as intended.

B. Interactive Elements (Buttons, Links, Toggles, Tabs)

- Every tappable element responds on tap.
- Tap feedback (ripple / highlight / color change) is visible.
- Disabled elements are visually distinct and cannot be activated.
- Elements change state correctly (enabled ↔ disabled, on ↔ off).
- Double-tap, long-press, and rapid taps do not cause errors or duplicate actions.
- Tab / menu selection highlights correctly and loads the right content.
- Back, close, cancel, and dismiss actions work on every screen.

C. Input Fields & Forms

- Empty submission shows proper validation message.
- Invalid input (wrong format, special characters, over max length) is rejected gracefully.
- Valid input is accepted and processed correctly.
- Required vs optional fields are clearly marked.
- Field labels, placeholders, and helper text are clear and correct.
- Keyboard type matches the field (number, email, text, etc.).
- Auto-capitalization, autocorrect, and paste behave correctly.
- Error messages are clear, specific, and disappear once fixed.
- Form remembers entered data on back-navigation (if expected).

D. Navigation & Flow

- Every navigation entry point leads to the correct screen.
- Back button returns to the expected previous screen.
- No dead ends — every screen has a way forward or back.
- Deep links / shared links open the correct screen.
- Transitions and animations run smoothly without lag or flicker.

E. Popups, Modals, Alerts & Notifications

- Popups open and close correctly.
- Tapping outside (if intended) dismisses them.
- Content inside popups is scrollable if it overflows.
- Alerts show correct title, message, and button labels.
- In-app and system notifications display and route correctly when tapped.

F. Data Handling

- Correct data is displayed for the current context / user.
- Lists load, scroll, and paginate smoothly.
- Pull-to-refresh (if present) reloads data correctly.
- Empty states display the right message and visual.
- Error states (failed load) show a clear retry option.
- Search, filter, and sort return accurate results.

G. Network & Interruption Behaviour

- Slow network — loading indicators shown, no infinite spinners.
- No network — clear offline message, no crash.
- Network switch mid-action (WiFi ↔ mobile data) handled gracefully.
- Incoming call / notification during action — app resumes correctly.
- App minimized and resumed — state preserved.
- App killed and reopened — resumes to expected screen.
- Low battery / device sleep during action — no data loss.

H. Device & OS Compatibility

- Tested on at least one small screen and one large screen device.
- Tested on at least two OS versions (one old, one latest).
- Tablet layout (if supported) renders correctly.
- System font size change does not break layout.
- System dark mode setting is respected (if applicable).

I. Performance Feel

- Screen loads within expected time.
- Scrolling is smooth, no frame drops.
- Animations play without lag or stutter.
- No noticeable overheating during extended use.
- No unusual battery drain.

J. Localization (if multi-language)

- Language switch updates all visible text.

- Translated text fits inside its UI container — no truncation.
- Date, time, number, and currency formats match the locale.
- Right-to-left layout (if applicable) renders correctly.

K. Accessibility

- All interactive elements have readable labels for screen readers.
- Tap targets are large enough and not too close together.
- Color is not the only way to convey information.
- Font scaling does not break the layout.

L. Install / Update / Uninstall

- Fresh install completes successfully.
- Update from previous version retains user data and preferences.
- First-launch flow appears only on fresh install, not on update.
- Uninstall removes the app cleanly, no leftover data.

M. Exit Checks Before Sign-off

- All blocker and critical bugs are fixed and retested.
- Regression pass is complete and green.
- Known issues are documented with severity and workaround.
- Final test report is shared with the team.

Bug Logging Format (for every failure): Title · Screen / Feature · Steps to Reproduce · Expected Result · Actual Result · Device · OS Version · Build Number · Severity (Blocker / Critical / Major / Minor / Cosmetic) · Screenshot or Screen Recording.

Apply this same checklist to every new feature and every regression cycle. Consistency across testers is what makes the output reliable.